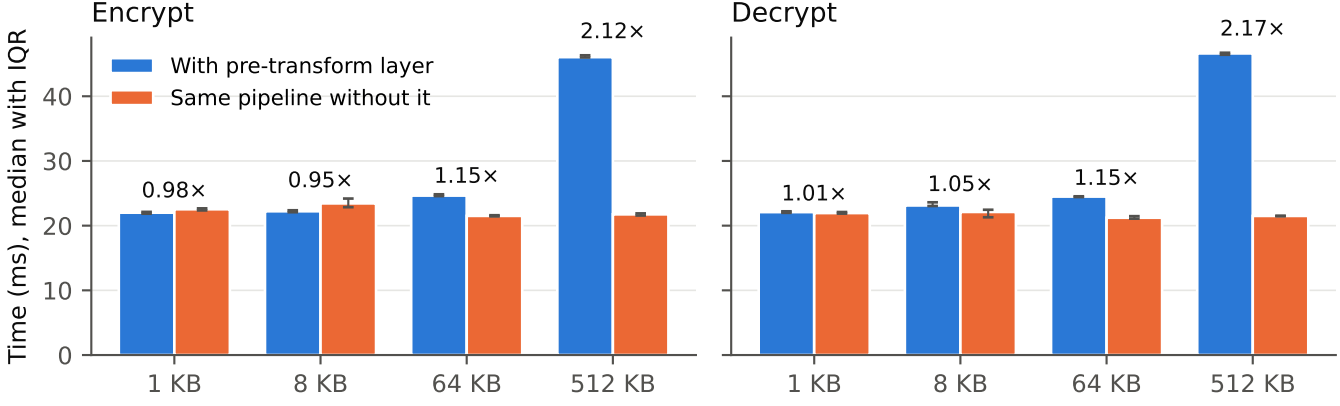A pre-transform layer is free at record sizes and a pure-Python tax at file sizes